U.S. Software

Security VaR Call: 2Q Data Points on Firewall, SASE, Data, Endpoint, Identity, & VM

Industry Update

We hosted a call with a large security VaR and came away with details on its 2Q performance of several specific vendors across network security (PANW, FTNT, CHKP), zero trust (ZS), data security (VRNS, RBRK), endpoint (CRWD), identity (OKTA), and VM (TENB). More on each below...

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We hosted a call with a value-added reseller (VaR) in cybersecurity and had several vendor-specific takeaways: (1) in network security, PANW is seeing healthy demand for firewall and the broader platform which is driving bigger deals, strength from 1Q continued into 2Q for FTNT (while some of this is coming from pull forward, pipeline shows this strength continues in 2H), and CHKP isn't seeing the same momentum in firewall but sees healthy demand in cloud and email security; (2) in zero trust, this VaR expects to come in-line with plan for ZS in July on several big deals in the pipeline, but more of this business is coming from renewals and expansions as opposed to new logos, as competition is driving more noise in the market; (3) in data security, VRNS is seeing healthy growth as data security is more of a priority and VRNS now has a larger platform to sell, and RBRK continues to win in cyber resilience with Microsoft and identity products resonating well; (4) in endpoint, CRWD sounds positive and continues to see demand in Agentic SOC and NG-SIEM, and Flex customers are renewing with more solutions; (5) in identity, OKTA is performing in-line and seeing success in CIAM, IGA, and AI security as it expands focus beyond traditional MFA/SSO; (6) in VM, this partner sounded good on QLYS, while softer on TENB – the caveat is that the sample size here sounds small, so we will continue to monitor this trend.

- **This VaR has a cybersecurity business that focuses on large enterprise customers, and saw continued strength in Q2 with June in particular showing good deal volume.** This reseller is a large technology partner that focuses on large enterprise customers in North America, and their overall business transacts across networking, infrastructure, compute and cybersecurity – the individual we spoke with works in the cybersecurity business which is the largest portion of the total revenue base. This reseller's global security business was above plan in Q2 (ended June), which continued the momentum from Q1 and reflected customer conversations around Mythos (which recall was first announced in early April) translating into actions as the quarter progressed. The top three areas that this reseller sees benefiting from Mythos-related conversations are (1) vulnerability and patch management tools, as attacks lead to organizations running more scans; (2) network architecture, including modernizing network security hardware like firewalls and a greater focus on microsegmentation; and (3) cyber resilience. We dig into vendor-specific takeaways in each of these categories of cybersecurity below.

- **For network security: (1) PANW was strong through June, as demand for hardware is healthy and deal sizes are growing as customers add Prisma Browser, Chronosphere, Prisma AIRS, and XSIAM to their EAs; (2) momentum from 1Q continued into 2Q for FTNT on strength in hardware firewall & SD-WAN – 10-15% of this was related to pull forward, but pipeline shows this strength could continue into 2H; (3) CHKP isn't seeing the same strength in firewall, but there is more momentum in cloud, email, and AI security/ Lakera.** PANW is this VaR's largest security partner and it saw strong performance in April, May, and June as PANW sales reps aren't waiting until the fiscal year end in July to get deals over the finish line. Zooming in, PANW's hardware business is doing well as customers are refreshing boxes, but this partner is also seeing customers add more to their enterprise agreements on top of the firewall, particularly in the face of more Mythos-related discussions – for example, customers are adding on Prisma Browser, Chronosphere, and Prisma AIRS. This partner is also seeing strong demand for XSIAM as customers are displacing legacy SIEM offerings like Splunk (acquired by CSCO, covered by Tim Long) with XSIAM – this is also expanding deal sizes as XSIAM can grow an opportunity by 30-40%. It also sounds like the CyberArk integration has gone well with many existing PANW customers now looking at the CyberArk solution. This partner does several hundred millions in annual revenue with FTNT and its FTNT business saw strong outperformance in 1Q which continued into 2Q – it sounds like y/y growth in 2Q was slightly below 1Q levels but still very strong and above plan. Zooming in, this partner attributed this strength to momentum in SD-WAN, hardware refresh, and a potential 10-15% increase in purchases related to customers pulling forward hardware purchases to get ahead of price increases. That said, this behavior isn't impacting pipeline as this VaR's FTNT pipeline shows record activity expected through the end of the year. Separately, this partner hasn't yet seen reports of more exploited FTNT vulnerabilities (named FortiBleed) impacting deal flow in the quarter or pipeline going forward. This partner does several hundred millions in annual revenue with CHKP and has not seen the same pickup in demand for hardware firewalls in its CHKP business as it has for its PANW, FTNT, and CSCO businesses – that said, this VaR is seeing momentum in CHKP's cloud network security and email security solutions as CHKP is landing new logos with Harmony Email and displacing some email security incumbents. Customer feedback on the Lakera acquisition also sounds positive with differentiated technology and more GTM investments from CHKP.

- **For SASE/Zero Trust: this partner expects to meet plan for ZS in July with a number of big deals in the pipeline, though more of that business is coming from existing customers rather than new logos as competition is growing.** This partner does several hundred millions in annual revenue with ZS with the bulk of its business coming from renewals and add-on business rather than new logos. Looking into July, this VaR has several large deals in the pipeline, which gives it confidence in meeting its plan for July, but it is seeing more competition in the SASE market which is creating some noise in RFPs. This partner also works with Netskope (NTSK, not covered) and has seen NTSK start to target large enterprise accounts more, in addition to the mid-market and service provider markets where it has historically been strong. This partner is seeing strength in its NTSK business overall and noted it is discounting less now/more in line with competitors.

- **For data security: (1) VRNS is seeing healthy growth as data security is a priority and VRNS has a bigger platform to sell now; (2) RBRK is leading in cyber resilience with identity resonating well.** This partner's VRNS business is smaller, but it is seeing strong y/y growth as data security is a growing priority for customers and Varonis has expanded its platform through several acquisitions which is starting to show up in results for this VaR

(Cyral in database activity monitoring, SlashNext in email security, and AllTrue in AI security). In addition, this partner has seen marketing efforts from a private competitor benefit Varonis which has a large, loyal installed base, and is seeing customers expand further with Varonis particularly for AI use cases and cloud environments. Cyber resilience has been a large area of focus for this reseller over the years which has led to a growing partnership with RBRK, and this business continues to sound encouraging – this partner sees RBRK winning head-to-head against other data protection vendors in conversations with security as the main driver, and with cyber resilience being a high area of priority under Mythos as we detail above, this should continue to benefit vendors like RBRK. This customer's overall RBRK business is in the tens of millions, and it sounds like solutions for Microsoft environments as well as identity resilience are both resonating well with existing customers. One area that many in the industry are paying attention to around RBRK is the impact of component shortages leading to longer lead times for backup hardware – this reseller is also watching this closely, but thus far it seems RBRK has continued to drive value for customers.

- **For endpoint security: (1) CRWD sounds good with Agentic SOC and NG-SIEM demand while also calling out growing upsell opportunities as Flex customers renew; (2) partner touched on new logo demand for SentinelOne's Prompt acquisition.** This partner's 2Q CrowdStrike business sounded positive, specifically calling out CRWD's Agentic SOC, NG-SIEM, Flex, and endpoint retention. On Agentic SOC, this partner continues to like CrowdStrike's opportunity to lead this market and believes the NVDA (covered by Tom O'Malley) partnership bolsters its position. On Flex, the partner noted that the first Flex customers are now lapping their initial deployment, highlighting that customers are "re-flexing" and adding more solutions. On endpoint specifically, it sounds like CrowdStrike's endpoint retention remains strong despite discounting from its competition. On SentinelOne, we did not hear as much compared to CrowdStrike, but it was good to hear this partner call out new logo opportunities for its recent Prompt acquisition.

- **For identity security: OKTA's performance was in-line with expectations, with this VaR seeing opportunity beyond MFA/SSO, calling out success in AI security with existing customer base, growing adoption of OKTA's IGA offering, and sales investments in CIAM.** OKTA business for this VaR is in the tens of millions and performance was in-line with expectations, with this partner noting that OKTA is seeing success moving beyond its traditional MFA and SSO offerings into other areas of identity. This VaR noted strong interest in OKTA's AI security products, which appear to be landing well within the existing customer base, while its IGA offering is gaining traction as customers continue to transition from on-prem to the cloud, highlighting that OKTA's IGA solution can displace other classic IGA vendors. This partner also called out CIAM as a key area of focus, noting that OKTA has invested meaningfully in its sales force around this product line. These comments are consistent with OKTA's efforts to build a more specialized sales motion with dedicated teams covering Workforce and Auth0 solutions separately.

- **For VM: QLYS demand sounded positive vis a vis TENB, but this partner's TENB business does not sound sizeable, so we will continue to monitor this trend.** In vulnerability management, this partner sounded particularly positive on QLYS (not covered). We wondered if part of this was because QLYS refreshed its go-to-market, primarily in the field, and has begun to move some of its remaining direct business to the channel. Despite the growing share that this partner may have from friendlier channel practices, it sounded like the QLYS business would still have outperformed TENB, although the caveat is that it sounds like this partner has a smaller sample size for TENB. Specifically, customers have renewed focus on their VM practices in a "post-Mythos" landscape, and we wonder if the stronger demand for QLYS is due to the perceived belief of strength in scanning/patching as well as being a less expensive alternative to TENB. To emphasize, this partner's TENB business does not sound sizeable, and this trend will be something that we will continue to monitor as we complete more security checks.

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Materially Mentioned Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)
Check Point Software Technologies Ltd. (CHKP, 06-Jul-2026, USD 138.87), Equal Weight/Positive, CE/J

CrowdStrike Holdings, Inc (CRWD, 06-Jul-2026, USD 199.38), Overweight/Positive, CD/CE/J

Fortinet, Inc. (FTNT, 06-Jul-2026, USD 162.35), Equal Weight/Positive, CD/CE/J

Okta, Inc. (OKTA, 06-Jul-2026, USD 148.60), Overweight/Positive, J

Palo Alto Networks (PANW, 06-Jul-2026, USD 357.53), Overweight/Positive, CE/D/J/K/L/M

Rubrik, Inc. (RBRK, 06-Jul-2026, USD 87.36), Overweight/Positive, CE/D/J/L

SentinelOne, Inc. (S, 06-Jul-2026, USD 18.15), Equal Weight/Positive, CE/FA/J

Tenable Holdings Inc (TENB, 06-Jul-2026, USD 41.29), Equal Weight/Positive, CE/J

Varonis Systems, Inc. (VRNS, 06-Jul-2026, USD 45.67), Overweight/Positive, CE/J

Zscaler, Inc. (ZS, 06-Jul-2026, USD 150.42), Overweight/Positive, CE/D/FA/J/K/L/M

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